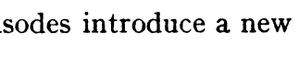
PRELUDE XIX

THIS three-part Invention (or Sinfonia) is a little Triple Fugue as strict as any Fugue in Bach's works, the first note in the bass being the only note outside the plan.

Of the three Subjects, the one that most needs bringing out is the syncopated theme first given to the middle part. The steady crotchet theme, which marks the time whether it is in the bass or elsewhere, can never fail to be heard however quietly it is played; whereas if the syncopated quavers are not put into the foreground they will mix themselves indistinguishably with the crotchets and lose both rhythmic and harmonic value. It is arguable, on the other hand, that the effect of their blending with the crotchets produces a valuable compound melody (as in Prelude XII. of Book I., and Prelude I. of Book II., etc.). This compound melody will, however, be evident enough, whatever success is attained in keeping the parts distinct. The surest way is to phrase the crotchet-theme *legato* in its semitone steps, and detached in its skips  . The syncopated theme then sings its suspensions with a *legato* broken only by the rests. Non-thematic bass quavers are best *staccato*.

The shake bracketed in bar 14 is necessary to the sense, and indicated by a ∾ interpolated in one of the autographs.

Four of the six possible permutations of the triple counterpoint are used in its six entries. The two Episodes introduce a new figure  (of which the phrasing here given is obviously right). They occur in bars 6½-8 and 14½-17. Climax is attained by the two successive entries of the triple counterpoint in the tonic from bar 17½-23.

The *tempo* is a graceful *Allegretto*, hardly beyond *Andante*.

FUGUE XIX

THE first thing to ascertain in this subtle and complex *scherzo* is the passages which recapitulate each other. They are obvious only when the player shows consciousness of them, and to emphasise them is to protect both player and listener from mere bewilderment in a jungle of cross-rhythm and obscure detail. First, then, we mark in bars 16-20 a passage which, starting from B minor, goes at bar 17 into E major (the dominant), and in that key comes to a formal close at bar 20. This evidently ends the first section of the piece, and soon afterwards we see semiquaver-movement breaking in and occupying a large middle section. At bar 42 this obviously ceases, and the matter of the first section is resumed. But what is more important and less obvious is that the formal close of bars 17-20 is reproduced in the tonic in bars 46-49. This is immediately followed by a final outbreak of semiquaver movement, of which the exact ante-

Donald Francis Tovey: The Well-Tempered Clavier, Book I
Associated Board, 1924. Printed pp. 122-123.
BWV 864. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
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cedents will be found in bars 29-30 (corresponding to bars 49-50). After this the cadence-phrase of bars 17-20 is given a third and last time, with the soprano and alto exchanging their parts, and the bass adding the semiquaver movement. This cadence-phrase will impress itself on the mind if it is duly brought forward, and there can be no question as to its importance in the scheme. The other passage (bars 29-30) is the first really differentiated Episode in the Fugue, if it may not rather rank as a couple of entries of a Second Subject; and it is very important that nothing should interfere with its recognition on recurrence in bars 49-50. We therefore have no hesitation in preferring to read in bar 30 what Bach would have written if his clavichord at the time had gone higher than C♮. Bischoff says truly that the limitation has given a special grace to this passage; but, on the other hand, the Fugue is much fuller of specially graceful details than of passages that give such recognisable features to its form, and we cannot afford to weaken these merely because Bach makes the best of a nuisance we need not continue to inflict on him. Students who (very rightly) wish to know the exact original here may note that at the join of bars 30-31 Bach had to take the lower instead of the upper B, C♯, and D.

As to the themes, the First Subject should be regarded as two bars long, though it is answered at one bar. The first note demands a distinct though not too grotesque *sforzando*, and the exact value of a quaver. Throughout the Fugue every quaver on the first of the bar thus followed by three quaver rests and a sequence of rising fourths will require this pronounced accent, whether the sequence follows in the correct position or not. The rest of the Subject should be a *legato* of bell-like distinctness, with whatever gradations between *pp* and *mf* seem best to bring out the form and the climaxes. The entry in bar 31 hands over the Subject from the top note of the soprano to the middle voice.

The semiquaver figures are of the nature of a Second Subject. This, however, is heard only twice in its integrity as a two-bar theme (bars 23-24 and 26-27), and requires all the more distinctness on that account. Its remaining traces are in the important passages described above. Elsewhere, any semiquaver scale-counterpoint satisfies the ear as representing its combination with the First Subject.

The *tempo* is an *Allegretto* in which bar 35 is not unplayable or unenjoyable after reasonable practice.